

DayFrame

Dogfood Pass 02 - Complete Findings

Future Hydration Record | Phase 9 product-reachability, usability, correctness, and two-surface migration evidence

Purpose. *Preserve the complete findings from Dogfood Pass 02 so a future DayFrame session can reconstruct what was observed, what worked, what failed, and what should be audited before the Planner/Summary migration.*

Status	Dogfood Pass 02 complete
Project stage	Phase 9 through Task 9.7 complete; convergence work pending
Primary migration direction	Two primary surfaces: Planner and Summary
Key audit question	How much Phase 8/9 capability exists but is unreachable through the old UX?
Finding count	78 consolidated findings

Executive Finding

DayFrame's underlying architecture appears substantially more capable than the current UX makes accessible. Several apparently missing capabilities may be implemented architecture that the old UX does not expose, implemented workflows whose entry points are disconnected or unclear, or genuinely incomplete product paths. That distinction must be audited before replacement logic is built.

*The pass also clarified the product distinction: **Commitments describe the things life requires. Goals describe the things the user wants DayFrame to help make possible.***

Commitments currently reach schedule generation, Friction, resolution, execution, and history. The intended Goal path - Demand, Capacity, Feasibility, Allocation, Proposal, user decision, Accepted Allocation, realization, scheduled Goal work, Progress - did not prove product-reachable during ordinary dogfooding. That is the largest functional question coming out of the pass.

A. Correctness and Engine Findings

1. Overnight beforeWork placement is systematically incorrect

With Night Shift Work such as 9:45 PM-6:15 AM, Workout configured with Preferred Window = Before Work was placed incorrectly during every tested Night Shift occurrence. It could overlap Work or become unplaced and generate Friction. Day-shift behavior appeared correct. Required invariant: a work-relative beforeWork Commitment must resolve against the actual start of the applicable Work interval on the canonical DayFrame day and must never be placed inside Work. If no valid opening exists, leave it unplaced.

2. Any available provides an important control case

Changing only Workout's Preferred Window to Any available eliminated the Friction while retaining the same 1-hour duration, 30-minute before/after buffers, M/W/F recurrence, and Night Shift configuration. This strongly narrows the defect to work-relative placement around overnight Work.

3. afterWork also needs overnight regression coverage

The eventual repair should test the entire work-relative placement family, including daytime Work, overnight Work, boundary crossing, cycle transitions, custom day boundaries, and no-valid-opening cases.

4. Friction detection works downstream

When invalid placement occurs, Friction correctly recognizes Work as locked and the flexible Commitment as movable. This suggests the authority model remains intact, but Friction must remain a safety net rather than routine repair for invalid generation.

B. Work Pattern and Schedule Authoring

5. Long rotating Work patterns are impractical to author

Repeating sequences require adding individual days. Real 21-, 28-, 35-day, or longer rotations need bulk construction: add runs of a shift/off days, duplicate/repeat patterns, and insert/copy blocks.

6. Two generations of Work configuration are exposed

The old repeating-sequence editor and newer dated cycle/segment model are both visible. Their semantic relationship must be audited and the product should expose one coherent model rather than architectural history.

7. Day boundary belongs contextually with Work Pattern

Day boundary is part of describing what a day means for shift workers. It should be visible/configurable in Work Pattern, with sensible defaults but explicit user override.

8. Week start may vary by Work cycle

The real test setup uses Sunday as the Night Shift work-week start and Monday for other cycles. The product should expose effective week start near cycle setup.

9. Cycle transitions should be visually apparent

Keep stable calendar columns, but visibly mark rhythm/cycle boundaries such as 'Day cycle begins - work week now starts Monday.' Do not redraw the month grid mid-month.

C. Commitment Authoring

10. Sleep should probably be a baseline Commitment

Sleep appears better suited to baseline setup with sensible defaults while remaining editable/removable.

11. Sleep placement language is inconsistent

Observed labels included Before Sleep and Before Day Boundary while behavior sometimes resembled Before Work. Audit actual semantics; do not merely relabel.

12. Sleep default priority/authority deserves review

Sleep should not behave like a disposable optional activity. Audit the priority scale before changing numbers.

13. Duration authoring is too machine-oriented

Use human hours/minutes in the UI while retaining canonical durationMinutes internally.

14. Duration controls should normalize

Examples: 8h 59m + 1 minute -> 9h 0m; 8h 0m - 1 minute -> 7h 59m, subject to valid duration.

15. Weekday recurrence controls need redesign

Replace the raw weekday checkbox row with clearer selectable day controls and useful shortcuts such as Weekdays, Weekends, and Every Day.

16. Commitment editing lacks contextual ownership

Editing one Commitment should open that Commitment's complete editor, not advanced editors for every Commitment.

D. Goals

17. Goal creation is too deeply buried

Goal creation/editing was found only through the Daily Workspace. Goals need globally discoverable access without becoming another primary application surface.

18. Goal decomposition is not exposed

Phase 8 Goal Structure exists architecturally, but dogfooding did not expose a meaningful decomposition workflow. Audit architecture versus UX exposure before implementing new logic.

19. Goal effort authoring is minutes-only

Time-based Goal demand should use human hours/minutes in the UI.

20. Ongoing Goals are not naturally representable

The current Goal workflow expects a target/end date. Persistent goals need explicit semantics.

21. Recurring Goals deserve explicit consideration

Recurring or ongoing Goal Demand should not simply be modeled as Commitment recurrence; the semantics differ.

22. Goal work still appears to require manual attachment to Commitments

The intended Capacity -> Allocation -> Proposal lifecycle did not surface during dogfooding. Manual attachment can make Goal-related work appear, but that is not the intended Phase 9 path.

E. Capacity, Proposal, and Plan

23. No Planning Candidate/Proposal was encountered

Normal dogfooding never surfaced a Proposal. Audit whether Capacity is absent, invisible, Demand is not reaching the path, Proposal generation lacks a product command, preconditions silently block it, or the old UX never connected the Phase 9 lifecycle.

24. Capacity has no meaningful user-facing representation

The underlying user question is simple: 'Where do I actually have room?' The product should answer that without exposing interval-topology machinery.

25. Constructive Goal planning remains unproven through the UI

The intended Goal -> Demand -> Capacity -> Feasibility -> Allocation -> Proposal -> Decision -> Accepted Allocation -> Realization -> Schedule -> Publication lifecycle was not successfully traversed from the product.

26. Plan is overloaded

Generated schedules, published plans, Plan History, Planning Range, and Planning Truth are distinct architectural concepts but not clearly distinguished in user-facing language.

F. Friction and Resolution

27. Resolve Schedule Conflicts appears nonfunctional

The button exists but did not expose an apparent resolution workflow. It should become the entry point to a proper Resolve Friction experience.

28. Repeated Friction needs bulk resolution

Repeated equivalent conflicts should support fixing one occurrence, applying a resolution to similar occurrences, or changing the underlying rule, while preserving explicit user authority.

G. Found Time, Manual Events, and Goal Work

29. Manual Goal-oriented activity should use Found Time

A manually entered Goal activity is not merely another Scheduled Event. The established concept is Found Time.

30. Scheduled Goal work and Found Time have different origins

Scheduled Goal work should originate from Proposal -> acceptance -> realization -> schedule. Found Time originates when the user unexpectedly invests time toward a Goal. Both may contribute evidence to Progress, but provenance differs.

31. Manual Event authoring lacks Goal association

Creating a Network+ Study Session provides no obvious way to associate it with the Network+ Goal. A Goal selector or equivalent relationship belongs in the Goal-oriented manual-event workflow.

32. Goal-associated manual events do not flow into Today/Progress as expected

The manually created study event did not appear alongside other actionable/completed Today items and did not advance Goal Progress in Summary.

33. Record New Value requires cumulative manual accounting

For time-based Goals, users should not have to calculate cumulative totals manually when DayFrame already knows the duration of a Goal-oriented activity.

H. Execution and Historical Reporting

34. Completed outcome records persist across app closure

After restarting DayFrame, completed task/outcome records remained present.

35. Deterministic schedule regeneration survives restart

Persisted authored setup can recreate the tested Commitment schedule, supporting the distinction between persisted authority and disposable derived schedule/Preview state.

36. Historical outcomes can be changed or removed

Today exposes Change Outcome and Remove Report for reported occurrences.

37. After-the-fact reporting is not sufficiently reachable

Users need a calendar-oriented way to select a past occurrence and report it after the fact; reporting should not depend on catching it in Today's current grouping.

38. Summary successfully aggregates execution history

Summary correctly showed outcome counts, reporting coverage, and completed details.

I. Summary

39. Scheduling Realization boxes look static but are buttons

Interactive metrics such as Scheduled, Unplaced, Omitted, and Blocked need clear interactive styling.

40. Expanded realization categories do not scale

A list of 17+ items becomes difficult to parse, especially on mobile. Prefer progressive disclosure, grouping, filtering, paging, or drill-down.

41. Summary's default historical range is not ideal

A better default would anchor to the current DayFrame day or nearest applicable user-week start.

42. Empty/redundant attention surfaces create noise

Plan Attention - Unplaced and Needs Attention should generally disappear when nothing requires attention.

43. Plan History correctly exposes absence of publication

Summary's lack of authoritative Plan History, combined with Today seeking a Published Plan, showed that the user had not successfully reached publication through the Goal planning workflow.

J. Today

44. Today distinguishes Published Plan from generated schedule state

This distinction is architecturally meaningful, but the product gives little guidance for reaching the state Today expects.

45. Today needs stronger canonical-DayFrame-day orientation

The current canonical day and, where useful, its boundary interval should be clear around midnight/nonstandard boundaries.

46. Today functionality belongs naturally in Planner's selected-day experience

Month already has Selected DayFrame Day; Today contains execution controls for the same conceptual object. These should converge into a Day Worksurface.

K. Month and Calendar

47. Month-to-Day navigation should be direct

Desktop single-click selects; double-click may open the Day Worksurface. Mobile tap selects with explicit Open Day. Keyboard needs an equivalent.

48. Previous and Next are ambiguous

In Month navigation they mean months, so labels or controls should communicate Previous Month / Next Month.

49. Monthly Planner should remain useful without schedule generation

The calendar should exist continuously; DayFrame planning should enrich it rather than gate it.

50. Move from generated Planning Window toward rolling/live calendar

The product should feel like an ongoing calendar while bounded computation horizons remain internal. Calendar horizon is not planning-computation horizon.

51. Logging-only use should be valid

Users should be able to navigate dates, add activity, associate Found Time with Goals, report outcomes, and inspect Summary without first engaging automated planning.

52. External calendar facts such as holidays belong in the live-calendar model

Holidays should be able to appear independently of generated DayFrame planning; source/import architecture remains to be designed.

L. Planning Range / Preview

53. Planning Range is physically too far from Work Pattern

They are architecturally distinct but should be UX-adjacent so users understand what period DayFrame will plan while configuring work rhythm.

54. Legacy three-day Preview default is confusing

A tiny old range can remain active while the user navigates a distant month.

55. Huge generated ranges make the old Preview navigator pathological

Hundreds of tiny date buttons create enormous vertical pages. Month should own temporal navigation.

56. Planning Range warnings are redundant and sometimes uninformative

Warnings should say what is wrong, why it matters, and what action is available, and should not be repeated without added value.

M. Architectural-Language Leakage

57. Selected-day planning truth is not user-facing language

The user wants to know what is planned for the day, not inspect 'truth.'

58. Canonical Planning Review is architecture language

Canonicity belongs in architecture/tests, not ordinary product copy. This area should converge into the Day Worksurface.

59. Template leaks provenance into historical completion records

Labels such as fitness - template and sleep - template describe internal provenance rather than what the user did.

60. Generated is engine-oriented grouping language

Normal scheduled Commitments should not primarily be grouped by engine provenance.

61. Architectural vocabulary needs a systematic migration audit

Audit terms such as canonical, truth, generated, template, realization, planning range, unplaced, proposal, allocation, and friction. Keep only terms that genuinely help users.

N. Navigation and Information Architecture

62. Three primary tabs should probably collapse to two surfaces

Current Planner | Today | Summary should converge toward Planner | Summary, with Today as a Planner workflow/mode.

63. Planner exposes too many peer destinations

Month, Commitment Library, Work Pattern, and Review Schedule are duplicated across navigation. Replace duplication with hierarchy.

64. Work Pattern and Commitments are natural peers

Both describe recurring structure of the user's schedule.

65. My Schedule is the strongest current name for that concept

Emerging hierarchy: Planner -> Calendar; My Schedule -> Work Pattern + Commitments; Goals; contextual Review Plan / Resolve Friction.

66. Goals need global discoverability without becoming a primary surface

Goals should be reachable from persistent Planner navigation or a nearby organizational layer.

67. Tasks may be useful vocabulary, but not as a domain merger

Commitments are closer to 'Need to do'; Goals are closer to 'Want to make progress toward.' They may share discoverability, but semantics must remain distinct.

O. Selected Day / Day Worksurface Convergence

68. Selected DayFrame Day and Today duplicate one another

Month already provides selected date, scheduled items, Add Event, Add Commitment, and editing; Today provides current-day grouping and execution reporting. They are partial implementations of one conceptual surface.

69. Canonical Planning Review should be reorganized into Day Worksurface

Selected-day planning information and Today execution controls should converge into one contextual day experience containing planned items, manual events, Found Time, Goal work, outcomes, and Friction/attention.

P. Empty States and Information Density

70. Empty attention panels should disappear

If there is no Friction, Unplaced work, or Needs Attention condition, do not reserve prominent space for empty problem panels.

71. Large detail lists need progressive disclosure

Prefer summary -> grouped count -> drill-down over summary -> expand everything inline, especially for mobile.

Q. Successful Behaviors Worth Preserving

72. Authored schedule setup persists

Work/Commitment setup survives application restart.

73. Generated Commitments regenerate deterministically

The tested schedule can be recreated from persisted authored authority.

74. Execution reports persist

Completed/skipped/etc. reports survived restart.

75. Historical reporting aggregates correctly

Summary reads historical execution records and calculates reporting coverage.

76. Friction identifies real incompatibility

Even when placement created the invalid situation, Friction correctly identified it.

77. Manual calendar events persist independently

Manual Events can exist even where generated schedule coverage is absent, an important foundation for the rolling-calendar direction.

78. Month is already becoming the natural product center

During testing, Month repeatedly became the place users expect to inspect, navigate, edit, add, report, reach Goals, and understand schedule state. This supports Planner/Calendar as the primary operational surface.

Largest Unresolved Architecture-vs-UX Question

How much of the Phase 8/9 architecture is already implemented correctly but unreachable through the old application shell?

The reachability audit should trace the ordinary constructive lifecycle end to end:

Goal -> Structure -> Demand -> Priority -> Capacity -> Feasibility -> Competition -> Allocation -> Proposal -> ProposalDecision -> Accepted Allocation -> Realization -> Schedule -> Review -> Publication -> Today/Execution -> Progress -> Summary/History.

Implementation evidence says this chain exists. Dogfood Pass 02 says a normal user cannot currently traverse it. The discrepancy should be audited before replacement logic is written.

Recommended Classification for Convergence Work

Classification	Representative findings
Correctness defects	Overnight beforeWork/afterWork; invalid work-relative placement
Product-reachability defects	No encountered Proposal; Capacity invisible; Goal -> Plan path unreachable; Found Time -> Progress disconnected
Authoring / interaction defects	Rotation authoring; duration controls; Goal access; recurrence controls; contextual editing; historical reporting
Old-shell / migration defects	Giant Preview calendar; Today duplication; Canonical Planning Review; navigation duplication; architectural language
Product evolution requirements	Rolling/live calendar; holiday/calendar facts; ongoing/recurring Goals; My Schedule hierarchy; Planner-Day convergence

Dogfood Pass 02 Conclusion

The established Commitment -> schedule -> execution/history path works surprisingly well, aside from a significant overnight work-relative placement defect. The newer Goal -> Capacity -> Proposal -> Accepted Allocation -> Realization path has not yet proven reachable through the product. Meanwhile, the old shell increasingly obscures the architecture underneath it.

Target product direction: *Planner becomes the operational center with a continuously useful Calendar, selected Day Worksurface, My Schedule (Work Pattern + Commitments), Goals, and contextual planning/review/Friction workflows. Summary becomes the home for Goals/Progress, plan and schedule outcomes, execution history, reporting, insight, and bounded drill-down.*

Under those surfaces, DayFrame should preserve its rigorous distinctions between authored authority, Capacity, Demand, Proposal, Accepted Allocation, schedule realization, publication, execution, Progress, and history. The user should benefit from those distinctions without needing to learn the architecture to operate the product.

Checkpoint: Dogfood Pass 02 is closed at 78 consolidated findings. The next phase should convert this evidence into a bounded architecture/UX reachability audit and convergence task before the two-surface migration.